

Team Worksheet — Lab 31

Consolidating Your Capstone — The A3 Storyboard

Team members: _____

Date: _____

1. Our understanding of the problem

2. Our working

Use the data in lab-31-a3-storyboard.xlsx.

3. What we produced

Deliverable: A complete A3 storyboard covering your full DMAIC project on a single page.

4. What the evidence does NOT tell us

5. Our conclusion

6. Step notes

Step 1. Retrieve every artifact you have produced since Lab 1 and lay them out in DMAIC order. You should have thirty or more pieces.

Step 2. Learn the A3 structure: Background, Current State, Goal, Root Cause Analysis, Countermeasures, Results, and Follow-up Actions.

Step 3. Write the Background in three sentences: the business context and why this project was selected from the portfolio.

Step 4. Present the Current State using your baseline — sigma level, capability, run chart and the quantified COPQ from Lab 1.

Step 5. State the Goal exactly as chartered, with the SMART target and the deadline.

Step 6. Summarise Root Cause Analysis with your strongest evidence only — the Pareto or stratification, the key hypothesis test result and the regression or ANOVA finding.

Step 7. Present Countermeasures: the selected solutions, the DOE optimum settings and the FMEA-driven risk mitigations.

Step 8. Present Results: before/after comparison, the statistical significance test, the control chart showing sustained performance, and the Finance-validated benefit.

Step 9. List Follow-up Actions: the control plan owner, audit schedule, open risks and the next project in the portfolio.

Step 10. Now edit ruthlessly to one page. Every element must earn its place — cut anything that does not change the reader's understanding or decision.

Step 11. Apply the visual test: a sponsor should grasp the whole story in 60 seconds from the charts alone, without reading the text.

Step 12. Have a peer read your A3 cold and tell you what the project did. If they get it wrong, the A3 is not yet finished.

7. Self-check

Your A3 fits on one page, covers all seven sections, carries your real project data throughout, and a peer reading it cold can correctly summarise the project.

Complete? ■ Yes ■ Not yet

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